

Tech Mock — QA Engineering

Sep 30, 2026, 10:22 PM ET

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[10:03 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Hi! I'm your AI interviewer for the Tech Mock — QA Engineering. This is a required interview for your career curriculum, and I'll ask you a set of questions one at a time. Take your time. Are you ready to begin?

[10:03 PM ET] You: Yes.

[10:03 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Great. Let's get started.

Here's a block of code. I'd like you to talk through it and explain what it is doing.

```
items = ["apple", "banana", "apple", "orange", "banana"]
duplicates = []
for item in items:
    if items.count(item) > 1 and item not in duplicates:
        duplicates.append(item)

print("Duplicates found:", duplicates)
```

[10:04 PM ET] You: Um, this code finds repeating items in a list, and it starts with a list of fruit names and a empty list called duplicates. Uh, for the loop check, each fruit, uh, the condition checks whether the fruit can appear more than once and whether it hasn't been added to duplicates. If both conditions are true, it adds the fruit. Apple and banana are each a pear twice, so they add once. Orange and pear is only once, so it isn't added. And, um, the final output is duplicate found apple and banana.

[10:04 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned the condition checks whether a fruit appears more than once. Can you tell me specifically which part of the code is doing that count, and how it works?

[10:04 PM ET] You: ...

[10:04 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your moment. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[10:05 PM ET] You: Um, the part that count is items.count items and prevent, uh, item. It counts as many times the current fruit appears in the entire item list. For example, when item is apple, it returns two point, then over one checks whether that the count is greater than one, which means fruit is repeated.

[10:05 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. And the second part of that condition, the "item not in duplicates" check — why do you think that's there? What would happen without it?

[10:06 PM ET] You: The "item not in duplicate" check makes sure each, uh, repeated fruit is added once. Without it, the loop will add an apple and a banana every time it encounters them

because their count are always greater than one. The duplicates list would become apple, banana, apple, banana, instead of apple, banana.

[10:06 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Alright, shifting gears a little. How would you explain the concept of functions or methods to someone learning programming?

[10:06 PM ET] You: Uh, a function is a reusable block of code that performs a specific task. You can give it an input, and it can return as a result. Uh, this helps you avoid repeating the same code. Uh, a method is a function that belongs to an object, like a list of a string, or an example, `item count apple` is a list method that returns how many times an apple appears. Another method is `duplicate append apple`. Apple adds apple to the duplicate list.

[10:06 PM ET] AI Interviewer: I see. You used the example of `items dot count` to explain a method. Can you walk me through how you would actually explain that to a complete beginner, someone who has never written a line of code before? What analogy or everyday comparison might you use?

[10:07 PM ET] You: I would compare a function to, like, a recipe. A recipe gives you steps for a task, and you can reuse it instead of writing the instructions again. The ingredients are like inputs, and the finished dish is the result. Uh, like, a method is like a built-in feature of, of a tool. For example, a phone has a feature for taking pictures in a... In Python, a list has a method called `count` for counting an item. When we write `items.count, like apple`, we're asking the list, "How many apples do you contain?"

[10:07 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Now, thinking about your work as a QA engineer — you've found a critical bug during testing. Describe the key information you would include in your bug report to ensure it's clear, actionable, and gets resolved efficiently.

[10:08 PM ET] You: I would include a clear title, the application version of testing environment and preconditions, uh, the exact steps to reproduce the bug. I would describe the expected result, actual result, and attach a screenshot or recording of the relevant logs. I'd also explain the user impact and how often the issue occurs. I would identify its severity and recommend a priority based on the impact and urgency. Since it's a critical bug, I'll notify the team immediately so they can investigate it quickly. After the fix, I'll retest the issue and check if any related functions after that.

[10:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. You mentioned attaching screenshots or recordings and relevant logs. Can you walk me through a specific time you did that — what the bug was, and how that evidence helped get it resolved?

[10:09 PM ET] You: For this question, I'll use a real example from, from my training, uh, what bug did I found. Um... And, um...

[10:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like a moment to think, or shall I move on to the next question?

[10:09 PM ET] You: I'm sorry.

[10:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: No need to apologize. Would you like to move on, or do you need a moment?

[10:09 PM ET] You: Yeah, can I move on?

[10:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Of course. Let's turn to the next one. You've reported a bug, and the developer claims they cannot reproduce it. What steps would you take to work with the developer to resolve this discrepancy?

[10:09 PM ET] You: ...

[10:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[10:09 PM ET] You: No.

[10:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[10:10 PM ET] You: I would first reproduce the bug again and check the report includes all the steps and preconditions. Now, to compare our environments, including the application, build, browser, and operating system with the test data and account permissions. I'll share screenshots and recording and relevant logs to show exactly what happened if we get different results. I'll walk through the steps of developer to identify the difference and update the report. Once it's fixed, I'll retest it and check the related features.

[10:10 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned comparing environments like the browser, operating system, and build version. Can you tell me more about why those differences specifically might cause a bug to appear on your side but not the developer's?

[10:11 PM ET] You: Those differences can change how the application behaves. Different browsers and browser versions may handle pages' layouts differently. Uh, the operating system can affect permissions, fonts, and file uploads. A different application may build also contain code changes or fixes that aren't in the version. For example, if a button fails in my browser, it may work in the developer browser. lip smacks Uh, I'll test the same application both in both browser versions. Uh, that helps me and developer to check whether the issue is related to the browser or another, uh, or in a different area.

[10:11 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Alright, let's turn to something a bit different. Describe a scenario where network connectivity issues could significantly impact the user experience of a mobile application, and how you would test for such scenarios.

[10:11 PM ET] You: One example is, like, losing the connection during a money transfer in a mobile app. Uh, the user might not know whether the transfer went through or could accidentally submit it again. Uh, I would test if it's a safe environment with slow connections, switches between Wi-Fi and cellular data, and disconnecting before, during, or after submitting the transfer. I'll check that the app shows a clear status, handles retries without creating a duplicate transfer, and displays the correct balance transaction history after reconnecting to the app or browser.

[10:11 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned testing with slow connections and switching between Wi-Fi and cellular. How would you actually simulate those conditions in a test environment — what tools or methods would you use?

[10:12 PM ET] You: For a slow connection, I would use a network throttle tool to limit the connection speed and add the delays, and let me repeat the test under controlled conditions. On a real device with cellular service, I would start on Wi-Fi, turn the Wi-Fi off during the transfer to force a switch to cellular to test if a complete connection lost. I'll definitely turn on an airplane mode to make sure the Wi-Fi is also off. I'll repeat these tests at different points in the transfer, then reconnect, and the transaction status, balance, error message, and whether the, any duplicate transfers occurred.

[10:12 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Now, thinking about cross-platform testing — if an app is available on both iOS and Android, would you expect the test cases to be exactly the same for both platforms? Why or why not?

[10:13 PM ET] You: ...

[10:13 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[10:13 PM ET] You: No, give me one second. Um, I would expect many test cases to be shared, for some would be different. Uh, core features like logging and then transferring money and checking balances should meet the same business requirements on both platforms. I would also include platform-specific cases because iOS and Android handle different navigations, uh, permissions and notifications. Uh, background behavior could be differently. Uh, for example, I'll check the Android system back navigation, um, and the app navigation to iOS. I'll also test supported devices and operating system versions to make sure that the app works correctly on each platform.

[10:13 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned platform-specific differences like back navigation on Android versus iOS. Can you walk me through a specific test case you would design around one of those differences, and what you'd be checking for?

[10:15 PM ET] You: I would test back navigation from money transfer confirmation screen, uh, before submitting the transfer. I'll enter amount, select the recipient, and continue the confirmation screen. On, on Android, I would use the system back button or gesture. On iOS, I would use the back button and swipe back gesture if supported. I'll check that both return to the correct screen, preserve or clear the entered details according to requirements, and don't submit a transfer. Then I would continue forward again to make sure the details are correct on the app and, and it remains responsive.

[10:15 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move to something else. A new feature on a social media platform allows users to upload profile pictures. Beyond basic upload functionality, what specific test cases would you design to ensure its robustness and user experience?

[10:16 PM ET] You: I would test the support and unsupported file types, corrupted files, file sizes just below or at the upload limit. I also would check different images dimensions and orientations to make sure cropping and previous work corrects correctly without stretching the

picture. For interruptions, I'll test a slow connection, connection loss, and a canceled connection, um, retrying a failed upload. Uh, if that check the errors are cleared and the previous picture stays in place if the upload fails. Finally, I'll verify the successful update appears correctly across the app and remains after refreshing or log back in. I also check the users can also change their own profile picture too.

[10:16 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned testing unsupported file types and corrupted files. What specific error handling would you expect the app to show in those cases, and how would you verify it's working correctly?

[10:17 PM ET] You: For unsupporting file type, I'll have a clear message explaining which formats are allowed, such as, "Please upload a JPG file or a PNG." For a corrupted image, I'll expect messages like, "This image couldn't be read. Please choose another file." I would upload a file in a disallowed format and supported image file with, uh, damaged contents. I'll check that each is rejected without crashing the app and showing false success message or replacing the existing profile picture. Then I'll upload a valid image to confirm that the user can recover and complete the upload.

[10:17 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Now, consider a web form for user registration. Beyond valid input, what are some edge cases or negative test scenarios you would consider to ensure the form's reliability and security?

[10:17 PM ET] You: I would test empty requirement fields, spaces-only input, invalid email formats, uh, an email that's already registered, or a password that doesn't meet the requirements. Also, check if the mismatched password confirmation and input lengths just below at and above the allowed limit. For security, I would test, uh, script-like inputs on the SQL injection strings to make sure that they aren't executed. I would also check the validation happened on the server, so if it can be bypassed through the browser. Finally, I would test repeated clicks on submit and connection loss during registration. I would check for clear error message, no duplicate accounts, and that the passwords aren't exposed in the responses on the logs.

[10:18 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned testing SQL injection strings and script-like inputs. Can you walk me through what you would actually enter into a field to test for that, and what you'd be looking for in the response?

[10:19 PM ET] You: In an authorized test environment, I might enter `OR 1=1` into a text field to check the SQL injection. I like for the database errors and expected success or exposed data. The input should be handling safely without changing the database query intended behavior. For a script test, I might enter script alert test script into a display name field. I'll check whether it executes with the name or displayed, including after and saving the re-opening the profile. It should be rejected or displayed safely as text. Uh, a missing pop-up or error alone would prove the app insecure, but those checks can, uh, identify as a vulnerability.

[10:19 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's turn to API testing. How can response codes help you troubleshoot issues in API testing?

[10:19 PM ET] You: ...

[10:19 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[10:20 PM ET] You: No, thank you. Um, the response...Code gives me, uh, a starting point for understanding what happens to an API request. For example, 200 usually means okay, 201 means resources were created, 400 is a problem request, 401 is a missing, 403 is a forbidden, and 500 is a server error. I would compare the codes with the expected result and check the response body headers and request details to investigate further. Uh, a successful status code alone doesn't prove the API works correctly. I would also verify the return data and expected changes.

[10:20 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned that a successful status code alone doesn't prove the API works correctly. Can you give me a specific example of a situation where you'd get a two hundred response but something would still be wrong?

[10:20 PM ET] You: For example, I could send a GET request for a user's profile and receive a two hundred response, but the response body may contain the wrong user information or be missing a required field. I would check the return user ID matches the request user, the required fields are present, and their values are, and data types are correct. The two hundred tells me the request succeeded, but the checks may tell me whether the result is actually correct.

[10:20 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. And finally, imagine you're testing an e-commerce website. Describe three different types of web testing you would perform before launch, and briefly explain the goal of each.

[10:21 PM ET] You: I would focus on function, performance, and security testing. For function testing, I'll check the user can search for products, add items to their cart, apply discounts, and complete the checkout without-- with the correct total. Um, for performance testing, I would check response times and re- uh, reliability under expected traffic and peak loads, especially during checkout. For security testing, I'll verify that the users can't access another customer's account or orders, and that the sensitive information is protected. The goal is to make sure the website works correctly, handles in demand, and protects the user's information.

[10:21 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned performance testing under peak loads, especially during checkout. Can you walk me through how you would actually set up that kind of test — what you'd simulate and what you'd be measuring?

[10:22 PM ET] You: I would set a realistic checkout flow in a test environment using a load testing tool. I'll simulate users adding products to their carts, entering checkout details, and submitting orders with a test payment service. I'll gradually increase the number of users to the expected peak traffic using realistic pauses between actions. I would measure response times, complete order per second, and error rates. I'll also monitor server resources usage to identify bottlenecks. Finally, I'll compare the result with agreed performance targets and verify the order charges and inventory updates remaining, remain accurate under the load.

[10:22 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. That brings us to the end of the interview. I really appreciate the time and thought you put into each of your answers. This interview is now complete and will be scored as part of your career programme. Best of luck!